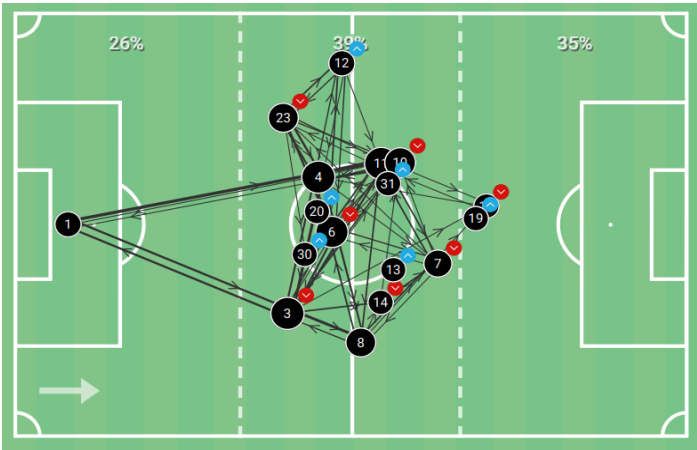


LEAD OPPONENT SCOUTING REPORT

Opponent: Ohio State
Date of Match: 10/03
Compiled By: Soham Mukherjee
Opponent Record: 5-0-4 in Fall 2025 (most recently 2-1 win against UCLA)

Overall Team Overview (over last 3 games):
Ohio State is a well-organized team that blends aggressive pressing up high with a compact central block when defending deep. They build through the middle via their CMs (#6, #11) and CBs (100+ possession recoveries each this season), then commit numbers forward, including high, wide fullbacks. Wingers drift inside for short passes and combination play. Right back #8 is error-prone under pressure defensively and has been involved in goals conceded. Offensive play runs through #7, a right-footed set-piece taker and leading scorer who also delivers accurate crosses. On corners, #15, #6, and #4 (out with RC) are key aerial targets. The team presses high with man-oriented positioning but shifts into a low, compact block deeper, prioritizing central coverage and numbers behind the ball.



Passing matrix vs Rutgers

PPDA	8.98	Aggressive pressing high up the field
Average Possession %	50.37%	Typically balanced, lower against UCLA due to an early red card
Passes per Possession	3.59	Prefers short quick combination play with central overloads
xG per 90	1.67	Relying partly on set pieces, cutbacks, and close-range efforts
Progressive Pass Accuracy	70%	Can efficiently advance the ball from buildup to attack
Interceptions per 90	45	Compact defensive shape aimed at blocking opponent progression centrally

In Possession:

- Shape: 4-4-2 or 4-1-3-2
- Builds through back 4 and CMs (#6, #11); GK often involved
- Wingers drift inside to combine centrally, overload central areas
- Fullbacks push up to provide width

Out of Possession:

- Defensive shape: 4-4-2 or 4-1-3-2
- High PPDA ~8.98; high block with man-oriented pressing in midfield
- Vulnerable in defensive transitions: exposed on the wings and gaps centrally against quick passing play

Key Players:

- #7 – Marko Borkovic (ST)
 - 3 G (2 pens) + 1 A in last 3
 - Set piece taker, right footed
- #11 – Luciano Pechota (CM)
 - Technical, links buildup
 - Leading in assists

AI Perspective: Confirms Ohio State's structured shape and occasional set-piece reliance (57.14% deep cross completion), highlighting central gaps and wing vulnerability (36% tackle success). Their xG suggests effective finishing when chances arise. Exploiting space available on the wings and quick passing play in the middle could be crucial.